

Ethan Charles Stuart

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data and AI product leader who ships. Lead a matrixed 50+ person data and AI product engineering organization at Disney Studios, serving 1,000+ downstream users, with time from spec to shipped cut from roughly four months to about one.

Built three enterprise data platforms 0→ 1 across financial services, restaurants, and entertainment.

Run the same AI-native operating model solo on a portfolio of production software: agent-reviewed specs, decision logs, shipped products with real users.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI-Native Operating Model: AI Coding Tool Deployment | Agent-Augmented Product Workflows | AI-Fluency Hiring | Cross-Functional AI Enablement Program Leadership

Leadership: Organizational Design | Operating Model Development | Strategic Planning & Roadmap Execution | Change Management & Platform Adoption | Executive Stakeholder Management | Matrixed Organizations

Enterprise Data: Platform Modernization | Customer Data Platforms (CDP) | Data Governance & Lineage | Event Instrumentation & Data Contracts | Experimentation | Feature Stores | Predictive Analytics

AI & Engineering: LLMs | Multi-Agent Systems | Semantic Search & RAG | Vector Databases & Embeddings | Evals | LLMOps | Agentic Orchestration | TypeScript | Next.js | Python | Supabase | Claude API

EXPERIENCE

The Walt Disney Company | Studio Technology and Operations Senior Manager, Data & AI Products and Analytics Engineering

June 2025 — Present

- Matrixed 50+ person org • 17 direct and matrix reports across 5 disciplines • direction for ~28 more via governance forums • 1,000+ downstream users • briefs CTO and President of Studio Technology and Operations monthly
- Cut time from spec to shipped from roughly four months to about one by establishing an AI-native operating model — AI coding tools as standard at 100% weekly active PM adoption (telemetry-tracked), agent-augmented PM workflows, AI-fluency hiring, and AI-built internal tooling including an in-daily-use PM portal.
- Multiplied platform stakeholders ~10x and brought on 10+ new partner groups through stakeholder-led change management, taking the platform enterprise-wide to 1,000+ downstream users.
- Established enterprise data governance, metadata, security, and quality frameworks across the full footprint; production pipelines run under documented freshness and quality SLOs.
- Shipped semantic search and talk-to-your-data into production — directed architecture across orchestration, Cypher, and RAG agents; integrated TwelveLabs multi-modal AI.
- Delivered a production chatbot suite for studio workflows; lead use case saves 6.5 hours per person per week.
- Owned platform build-vs-buy — consolidated BI onto a single enterprise analytics stack (retired a legacy reporting vendor), and selected Snowflake Cortex + Neo4j over leading vector-search and RAG vendors for governance and Snowflake-native lineage.
- Delivered production ML forecasting and decision-support models for studio finance (cash flow, quarterly budget); contributor to the studios' cross-company finance transformation.
- Mentor 5 PMs beyond the immediate org; led multiple contractor-to-FTE conversions and several direct-report moves into expanded scope.

Yum Brands | Taco Bell Portfolio Manager, Product, Data & Analytics Platform

January 2025 — June 2025

- 25+ person matrix team • all enterprise data products • 7,000+ operators and executives served
- Reduced platform incidents 85% (12→ 1–2 P1/P2 monthly) and increased satisfaction 50% in 60 days by converting a service team into a product organization — prioritization frameworks, transparent stakeholder communication, org-wide BI standards.
- Shipped reporting structure, governance frameworks, and Microsoft Fabric + Gen AI capabilities; partnered on AI drive-thru, digital menu boards, and Cantina launches.
- Delivered ML models for labor prediction and CRM, plus platform support for digital marketing and e-commerce.
- Expanded from CDP to the full platform portfolio after demonstrating rapid impact.

Staff Product Manager, Enterprise Customer Data Platform

June 2023 — January 2025

- All Yum brands — Taco Bell, KFC, Pizza Hut • 14-person team across product, engineering, and analytics
- Drove CDP adoption across Taco Bell, KFC, and Pizza Hut — led implementation and GTM enabling 80% YoY loyalty growth (CDP contribution validated via marketing mix model).
- Shipped ML models and pipelines for retention, lapse prediction, and CRM insights; delivered intelligence to 7,000+ operators through in-store reporting, regional dashboards, and franchisee tracking.
- Moved the group from order-takers to a strategic product organization and increased satisfaction 40%.

Capital Group Product Manager, Data Platforms & Strategic Automation

August 2022 — June 2023

- All Capital Group ETFs and Mutual Funds • roadmap across Marketing, Sales, and Compliance

- Launched the Phoenix Fire data platform 0→ 1 to 100% enterprise adoption — consolidated tools, automated workflows, and modern UX transformed sales and marketing operations.
- Shipped through 3 ETF launches while managing a unified roadmap across Marketing, Sales, and Compliance.
- Established a data governance framework with proactive quality monitoring and stakeholder notification, in a highly regulated context.

Sprout Mortgage Manager, Analytics & Product Strategy

October 2021 — August 2022

- | Enterprise analytics function built from scratch • 85 sales professionals supported
- Built the enterprise analytics function from scratch — standardized reporting and drove a 15% loan origination increase across 85 sales professionals.
- Integrated Power BI with a custom CRM, delivering self-service analytics and pipeline visibility to 4 VPs, 10 regional managers, and 85 loan officers.

Earlier: investment analysis and BI leadership at Pacific Urban Investors (2018–2021) and Civic Financial Services (2016–2018).

PRODUCTS BUILT INDEPENDENTLY

Production software architected and shipped solo through AI coding tools, using the same operating model deployed at Disney but without an organization behind it.

- **Allison's Kitchen** (allisonskitchen.app) — Household kitchen software. Recipe capture from a link, a photo, or a video; weekly meal planning; step-by-step cook mode. Built for one household first, now in invite-only release with families onboarding in batches; iOS build in UAT. Next.js + Supabase.
- **NexusWatch** (nexuswatch.dev) — Real-time geopolitical intelligence. 45+ live data layers across 86 countries (conflict, disasters, infrastructure, intelligence, environment), an LLM analyst synthesizing threat patterns, and an MCP server for AI agent access. Open source, paired with a daily geopolitical-risk brief with subscribers. Vite + TypeScript + MapLibre GL + Supabase + Claude API. Live since April 2026.
- **Altogether** (longtable.dev) — Multi-household trip planning. Households submit availability and budget privately; an AI co-planner reconciles them into workable windows and per-household costs. In development.

Also in development: **The Composer** (agentic editorial framework; a ten-persona editorial board gating a notes → draft → review → publish pipeline), **Product OS** (spec-as-code for PMs; OSS CLI and PR-based spec workflows), and **Gridiron** (sports forecasting and calibration testbed scored against public closing lines). Separately maintain a paper-traded systematic trading research platform with walk-forward evaluation and SEC EDGAR insider-signal modeling, with no real capital deployed.

WRITING & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Data Product Agent (thedataproductagent.substack.com) — Data products, AI-native team operating models, multi-agent systems, and building enterprise software through AI coding tools.

EDUCATION

Loyola Marymount University — B.B.A. in Finance and Economics

CERTIFICATIONS

AI Fundamentals for Non-Data Scientists — University of Pennsylvania, Wharton (Credential ID: 9QM1CR10FD5F)

Databricks Academy Accreditations — Generative AI Fundamentals + Lakehouse Fundamentals (Credential IDs: 112741113, 112676552)